



## Fox on fire. Back in the game.

In an attempt to gain back its lost users and developers, great changes are being made in Firefox. <http://dgit.in/chngedfox>



## These kids

What will make teenagers less impatient? Brain connectivity <http://dgit.in/tngdrama>

# Gigabyte GA-Z97X-UD3H-BK

A well-rounded Z97 motherboard

**M**otherboards are often given the least priority when it comes to coming up with a new configuration but if your work depends on your rig then you might want to give motherboards a little extra thought. And with reliability being a concern you'd be better off with boards like the Gigabyte GA-Z97X-UD3H-BK which boasts of 168-hour severe level durability test coupled with a 5-year warranty period.

It's been awhile since we saw PCI slots make an appearance on motherboards and the GA-Z97X-UD3H-BK is one of those boards. Like many ATX boards now-a-days even this board makes use of the



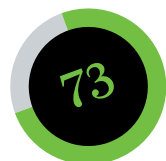
Price  
₹16,000

Realtek ALC 1150 for sound along with separate layers for left and right channels. However, there isn't any EMI shielding for the chip itself. The heatsinks are not high and cover the VRM chips while providing ample amount of clearance for the chokes and subsequently makes way for large CPU coolers.

This isn't a full-ATX board in terms of physical dimensions. Ordinarily, ATX boards are 305 x 244 mm but the GA-Z97X-UD3H-BK is 305 x 225 mm. This two centimetre reduction isn't much when you think of all the real estate that goes to waste on motherboards. However, the fallout of this reduction is that the mounting screws on the right edge of the board are no longer present. This does affect the rigidity of the motherboard overall and you might need to be a little careful while yanking out the 24-pin ATX power cable from the board.

Overall, the Gigabyte GA-Z97X-UD3H-BK makes for a good choice if you want all the features of the Z97 chipset along with server level durability.

Mithun Mobandas



Features .....65  
Build .....80

## Specifications

**Chipset:** Intel Z97; **Memory support:** 4x3100(OC) MHz upto 32GB; **LAN:** Intel Gigabit Ethernet; **Audio:** ALC1150 7.1; **SATA:** 6x SATA III; **Expansion:** 3x PCIe X16(x16+x8+x4); **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 305 mm x 225 mm; **Warranty:** 5 years

## Contact

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# Seagate Seven

The iPhone of portable hard drives

**I**t's been quite a while since we've seen a hard drive ever come in packaging like the Seagate Seven. If it weren't for the full-sized images emblazoned across the packaging, you'd be forgiven for assuming that the packaging belonged to some premium smartphone. Well, it isn't a phone but it certainly does look and feel premium. The Seagate Seven is the slimmest portable hard drive that we've come across. Prior to this device, the slimmest we'd seen was the ADATA HE720 which in itself was 8.9mm thick. The drive comes ensconced in thick foam along with the USB 3.0 cable, which again is enclosed by a thick cardboard box.

The drive itself maintains a very clean look with no elements that look out of place. The body seems to be constructed out of fairly thick stainless steel which



Price  
₹9,500

is a necessity in this case since the body hugs the internal drive very closely and having an rigid internal chassis isn't feasible.

The Seagate Seven houses a Seagate Laptop Ultrathin HDD which is 5 mm thick. Speaking of which, the Laptop Ultrathin HDD has performance figures which are comparable to most 5400 RPM drives out there. So on the performance front there isn't a compromise on speed in lieu for the really slim form factor. In our tests, we saw sequential read speeds averaging out at 112.5 MBps and sequential write speeds of 110.3 MBps and with smaller file sizes having a long queue depth the transfer speeds dropped down to about 40 MBps.

The Seagate Seven comes loaded with Seagate Dashboard which brings most of the features that the drive sports. And as of June 2015, Seagate Dashboard gives the user 200 GB of Cloud Storage which is a lot more than the paltry amount that used to ship with every other drive till now. And for the premium look and feel you do end up shelling out a lot more than you'd normally have to for a 500 GB portable hard drive, a good ₹9,500.

Mithun Mobandas



Performance.....59  
Features .....85

## Specifications

**Model:** STDZ500400; **Capacity:** 500 GB; **Interface:** USB 3.0; **Colour:** Nude Metal; **RPM:** 5400; **Dimensions:** 122.5 x 82 x 7 mm; **Weight:** 198 gm; **Warranty:** 3 Years

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